Prolific Poll (US) | October 2026

Full questionnaire: 2026 midterm generic ballot and political trackers

Fieldwork	21–22 October 2026
Mode	Online, self-administered; survey scripted in Qualtrics. About 4 minutes.
Sample	US adults on Prolific's opt-in online participant panel, invited using propensity-score sampling: a model of how the panel differs from the US adult population on age, sex, race, education, region and 2024 and 2020 presidential vote defined 25 groups, each invited in proportion to its population share. 1,518 US adult citizens analysed (non-citizens and one duplicate session excluded).
Profile data	2020 presidential vote is taken from Prolific's participant-level profile data and is not asked in this survey. 2024 presidential vote from the profile was used to invite participants; it is also asked in the survey (Vote2024).
Randomisation	(1) Order of the parties in the generic-ballot question: half of respondents saw the Democratic candidate listed first, half the Republican candidate first (even presentation). (2) Topic-choice experiment: a random half of respondents were first asked which topic they would like to give opinions on; the other half went straight to the political questions. See Section 2.
Question order	As printed below, following the fielded survey flow: Introduction and consent, Topic-choice experiment (random half), Political questions, About you, Additional questions, End.
Source	Transcribed directly from the fielded Qualtrics survey file. Numeric answer codes are omitted for readability; question wording, option order and display logic are reproduced as fielded. Every question required an answer.

1 Introduction and consent

Consent

Hello! Thank you for taking part in the Prolific Poll.

This short survey (about 4 minutes) is run by the Prolific team. We will ask about your views on current issues and a few questions about you.

You may also be invited to two very short paid follow-up surveys in the following weeks. Participating in those follow-up surveys is not mandatory.

Please answer honestly. All data will be kept fully anonymous at all times.

Are you happy to continue?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

Respondents who selected "No" were routed straight to the end of the survey.

2 Topic-choice experiment (random half of respondents)

Shown only to the random half assigned to the experiment; the other half went straight to Section 3. Everyone, whichever topic they picked, then answered all the political questions in Section 3. Respondents who picked politics went straight to Section 3; those who picked another topic first answered the one question for that topic, then saw a short transition

screen.

TopicChoice

For which of the following would you like to provide your opinions?

- ○ Movies
- ○ Politics
- ○ Health
- ○ Sports

SportsRate

How would you rate each of the following athletes?

	Very favorable	Somewhat favorable	Somewhat unfavorable	Very unfavorable	Haven't heard enough
Patrick Mahomes	○	○	○	○	○
Shohei Ohtani	○	○	○	○	○
Caitlin Clark	○	○	○	○	○
Lionel Messi	○	○	○	○	○

Shown if "Sports" was selected at TopicChoice. Athletes shown in the order listed.

HealthExercise

In a typical week, on how many days do you do at least 30 minutes of physical exercise?

- ○ 0
- ○ 1
- ○ 2
- ○ 3
- ○ 4
- ○ 5
- ○ 6
- ○ 7

Shown if "Health" was selected at TopicChoice.

MoviesFreq

How often do you watch a movie, either at home or in a cinema?

- ○ Every day or almost every day
- ○ A few times a week
- ○ About once a week
- ○ A few times a month
- ○ Less often
- ○ Never

Shown if "Movies" was selected at TopicChoice.

Transition

Thank you. We would also like your views on some current issues.

Shown to respondents who did not select "Politics" at TopicChoice, before Section 3. Information screen; no response.

3 Political questions

Asked of all respondents.

TrumpApprove

Do you approve or disapprove of the way Donald Trump is handling his job as president?

- ○ Strongly approve
- ○ Somewhat approve
- ○ Somewhat disapprove
- ○ Strongly disapprove
- ○ Not sure

RightTrack

Generally speaking, would you say things in this country are heading in the right direction, or are they off on the wrong track?

- ○ Right direction
- ○ Off on the wrong track
- ○ Not sure

CongressApprove

Do you approve or disapprove of the way that the United States Congress is handling its job?

- ○ Strongly approve
- ○ Somewhat approve
- ○ Somewhat disapprove
- ○ Strongly disapprove
- ○ Not sure

LikeVote

How likely are you to vote in the midterm election for the U.S. Congress on November 3, 2026?

- ○ Definitely will vote
- ○ Probably will vote
- ○ Maybe / 50-50
- ○ Probably will not vote
- ○ Definitely will not vote
- ○ I have already voted
- ○ I am not eligible to vote

LikeVote10

On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 means you will definitely not vote and 10 means you will definitely vote, how likely are you to vote in the election for the U.S. Congress on November 3, 2026?

- ○ 0
- ○ 1
- ○ 2
- ○ 3
- ○ 4
- ○ 5
- ○ 6
- ○ 7
- ○ 8
- ○ 9
- ○ 10

GenBallot

If the election for U.S. Congress were held today, would you vote for the Democratic Party candidate or the Republican Party candidate in your district?

If you have already voted, please tell us how you voted.

- ○ The Democratic Party candidate
- ○ The Republican Party candidate
- ○ Other
- ○ Not sure
- ○ I would not vote

One of two versions, assigned at random with even presentation: half of respondents saw the Democratic Party candidate listed first (shown here), half saw the Republican Party candidate first (GenBallotRfirst, below). Wording otherwise identical.

GenBallotRfirst

If the election for U.S. Congress were held today, would you vote for the Democratic Party candidate or the Republican Party candidate in your district?

If you have already voted, please tell us how you voted.

- ○ The Republican Party candidate
- ○ The Democratic Party candidate
- ○ Other
- ○ Not sure
- ○ I would not vote

Version with the Republican Party candidate listed first; shown to the other half of respondents.

GenBallotLean

If you had to choose, which party's candidate do you lean toward?

- ○ The Democratic Party candidate
- ○ The Republican Party candidate
- ○ Neither / still not sure

Shown if "Not sure" was selected at the generic-ballot question. Respondents saw the version with the same party order as their generic-ballot question (GenBallotLeanRfirst lists the Republican Party candidate first).

VoteCertainty

How certain are you about this choice?

- ○ Completely certain
- ○ Very certain
- ○ Moderately certain
- ○ Slightly certain
- ○ Not at all certain

Shown if the respondent had not already voted and was not ineligible (LikeVote), and chose a candidate at the generic-ballot question (not "Not sure" or "I would not vote").

AlreadyVotedConfirm

Just to confirm: have you already cast your ballot in the November 3 election, either in person or by returning a mail ballot?

- ○ Yes, I have already voted
- ○ No, not yet

Shown if "I have already voted" was selected at LikeVote.

AlreadyVotedHouse

Did you vote in the race for the U.S. House of Representatives in your district?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No, I did not vote in that race
- ○ Not sure

Shown if "Yes, I have already voted" was selected at AlreadyVotedConfirm.

RegVote

Are you currently registered to vote at your current address?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No
- ○ Not sure
- ○ I cannot register to vote

PartyID

In politics today, do you consider yourself a Republican, Democrat, independent, or something else?

- ○ Republican
- ○ Democrat
- ○ Independent
- ○ Something else

PartyLean

As of today do you lean more to the Republican Party or the Democratic Party?

- ○ The Republican Party
- ○ The Democratic Party
- ○ Neither

Shown if "Independent" or "Something else" was selected at PartyID.

Vote2024

Who did you vote for in the 2024 US presidential election?

- ○ Donald Trump
- ○ Kamala Harris
- ○ Other candidate
- ○ I did not vote
- ○ I did not have the right to vote
- ○ Rather not say

4 About you

Asked of all respondents.

Citizen

Are you a citizen of the United States?

- ○ Yes, born in the United States
- ○ Yes, born in Puerto Rico, Guam, the U.S. Virgin Islands, or Northern Marianas
- ○ Yes, born abroad of U.S. citizen parent or parents
- ○ Yes, U.S. citizen by naturalization
- ○ No, not a U.S. citizen

Respondents who are not US citizens are excluded from all estimates.

Age

What is your age?

- ○ 18-24
- ○ 25-34
- ○ 35-44
- ○ 45-54
- ○ 55-64
- ○ 65 or older

Sex

What is your sex?

- ○ Male
- ○ Female

Hispanic

Are you of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin?

- ○ No, not of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin
- ○ Yes, Mexican, Mexican American, Chicano
- ○ Yes, Puerto Rican
- ○ Yes, Cuban
- ○ Yes, another Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin

Race

What is your race? Select all that apply.

- ☐ White
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native
- ☐ Asian
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
- ☐ Some other race

More than one answer could be selected.

Educ

What is the highest degree or level of school you have completed?

- ○ Less than a high school diploma
- ○ High school diploma or GED
- ○ Some college, no degree
- ○ Associate degree
- ○ Bachelor’s degree
- ○ Master’s degree
- ○ Professional degree or doctorate

State

In which US state do you live?

- ○ Alabama
- ○ Alaska
- ○ Arizona
- ○ Arkansas
- ○ California
- ○ Colorado
- ○ Connecticut
- ○ Delaware
- ○ District of Columbia
- ○ Florida
- ○ Georgia
- ○ Hawaii
- ○ Idaho
- ○ Illinois
- ○ Indiana
- ○ Iowa
- ○ Kansas
- ○ Kentucky
- ○ Louisiana
- ○ Maine
- ○ Maryland
- ○ Massachusetts
- ○ Michigan
- ○ Minnesota
- ○ Mississippi
- ○ Missouri
- ○ Montana
- ○ Nebraska
- ○ Nevada
- ○ New Hampshire
- ○ New Jersey
- ○ New Mexico
- ○ New York
- ○ North Carolina
- ○ North Dakota
- ○ Ohio
- ○ Oklahoma
- ○ Oregon
- ○ Pennsylvania
- ○ Rhode Island
- ○ South Carolina
- ○ South Dakota
- ○ Tennessee
- ○ Texas
- ○ Utah
- ○ Vermont
- ○ Virginia
- ○ Washington
- ○ West Virginia
- ○ Wisconsin

- ○ Wyoming

Drop-down list.

Community

How would you describe the community where you live?

- ○ Urban
- ○ Suburban
- ○ Rural

Marital

What is your marital status?

- ○ Now married (except separated)
- ○ Widowed
- ○ Divorced
- ○ Separated
- ○ Never married

Tenure

Is the house, apartment, or mobile home where you live…

- ○ Owned by you or someone in your household with a mortgage or loan
- ○ Owned by you or someone in your household free and clear
- ○ Rented
- ○ Occupied without payment of rent

Children

Do any of your own children under 18 (including stepchildren and adopted children) live with you?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

WorkLastWeek

Last week, did you work for pay at a job or business?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

Veteran

Have you ever served on active duty in the U.S. Armed Forces, Reserves, or National Guard?

- ○ Never served in the military
- ○ Only on active duty for training in the Reserves or National Guard
- ○ Now on active duty
- ○ On active duty in the past, but not now

HealthIns

Are you currently covered by any of the following types of health insurance or health coverage plans? Select all that apply.

- ☐ Insurance through a current or former employer or union (of you or a family member)
- ☐ Insurance purchased directly from an insurance company (including the Marketplace)
- ☐ Medicare
- ☐ Medicaid, Medical Assistance, or any government-assistance plan for those with low incomes or a disability
- ☐ TRICARE or other military health care
- ☐ VA (including those who have ever used or enrolled for VA health care)
- ☐ Indian Health Service
- ☐ Any other type of health insurance or health coverage plan
- ☐ No health insurance or coverage of any kind

More than one answer could be selected.

Religion

What is your present religion, if any?

- ○ Protestant (for example, Baptist, Methodist, Non-denominational, Lutheran, Presbyterian, Pentecostal, Episcopalian, Reformed, Church of Christ)
- ○ Roman Catholic
- ○ Mormon (Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints)
- ○ Orthodox (such as Greek, Russian, or some other Orthodox church)
- ○ Jewish
- ○ Muslim
- ○ Buddhist
- ○ Hindu
- ○ Atheist
- ○ Agnostic
- ○ Something else
- ○ Nothing in particular

HHIncome

What was the total income of all members of your household during the past 12 months, before taxes?

- ○ Less than $25,000
- ○ $25,000 to $49,999
- ○ $50,000 to $74,999
- ○ $75,000 to $99,999
- ○ $100,000 to $149,999
- ○ $150,000 to $199,999
- ○ $200,000 or more
- ○ Rather not say

5 Additional questions

Asked of all respondents.

Vote2022

In the November 2022 elections for the U.S. House of Representatives, did you vote?

- ○ Yes, I voted
- ○ No, I did not vote
- ○ I was not eligible to vote
- ○ I don't remember

Vote2022Party

Which party's candidate did you vote for in the 2022 House election?

- ○ The Democratic candidate
- ○ The Republican candidate
- ○ Another candidate
- ○ I don't remember

Shown if "Yes, I voted" was selected at Vote2022.

Volunteer

In the last 12 months, have you done any volunteer work through or for an organization?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

ReligAttend

Aside from weddings and funerals, how often do you attend religious services?

- ○ More than once a week
- ○ Once a week
- ○ Once or twice a month
- ○ A few times a year
- ○ Seldom
- ○ Never

AttnCheck

To show that you are reading carefully, please select "Rarely" from the options below.

- ○ Always
- ○ Often
- ○ Sometimes
- ○ Rarely
- ○ Never

HowFound

How did you find this study?

- ○ On my Prolific study list
- ○ From a Prolific email or notification
- ○ Other

6 End

End

Thank you for taking part!

Click the arrow below to complete your submission and return to Prolific.

Closing screen; no response.